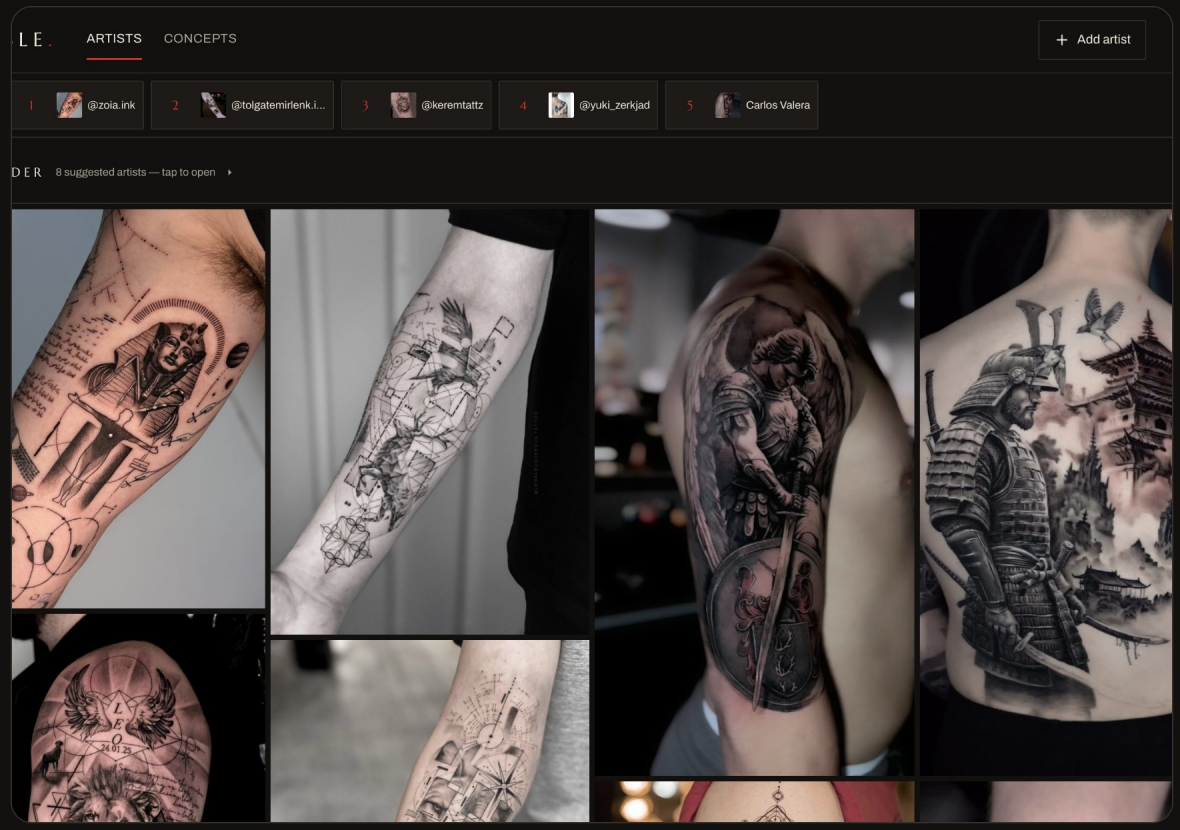
HOW I USE AI · BUILDING SOFTWARE

SABLE

One developer, a fleet of agents

A tattoo collector's app, built with Claude Code, Codex and Antigravity. March to October 2026.



From issue to merge

All work comes from one GitHub backlog. Claude, Codex and the other models all pick their tasks from it.

01

Backlog

Every task is a GitHub issue labelled backlog. A model claims one with an in-progress label.

→

02

Agent

Claude Code or Codex writes the tests first, in its own git worktree. Several run in parallel.

→

03

Critics

Codex and Antigravity review the diff, read-only. I verify every finding.

→

04

CI

Vitest, Playwright browser tests, CodeQL and SonarQube.

→

05

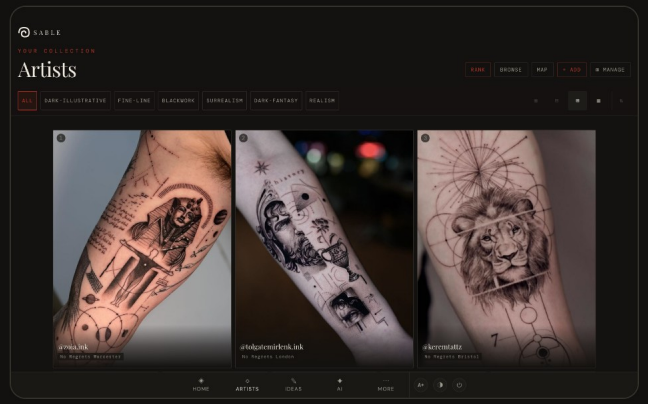
Merge

Squash-merge, deploy to GitHub Pages, smoke-test the live demo.

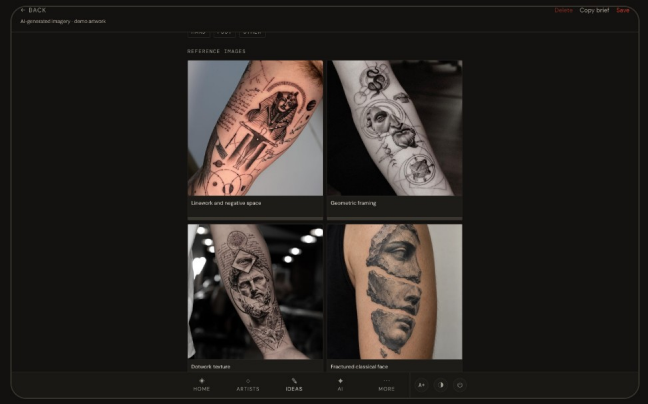
56 of 58 tasks passed CI on the first run.

From the ledger's task records, alongside 40 cross-model review runs.

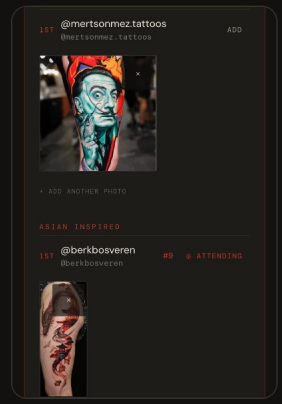
Every tattoo artist I love, in one place



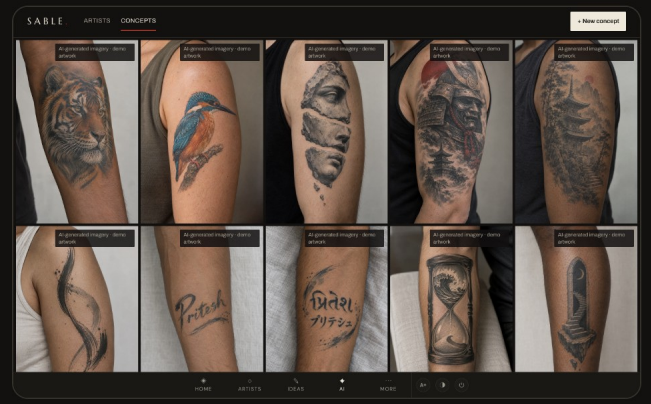
Artists



Ideas



Radar



AI concepts

448
commits since 18 March

92
GitHub issues closed

248
test files, unit and browser

25k
lines of app source

React 19 · React Router 8 · Tailwind 4 · Vite 8 · installable web app with sync · on-device CLIP taste matching · Gemini vision screenshot intake

What's inside

OpenAI · Gemini

AI concepts

Describe a tattoo and generate it with my own key, or copy the prompt into any chatbot.

STL · in the browser

3D relief export

Any concept image becomes a 3D-printable relief, built on the device.

CLIP · on-device

Similar ink

Finds artists whose work looks like the ones I love, and maps my whole gallery by look.

Share sheet · Gemini vision

Screenshot intake

Share an Instagram screenshot to Sable and the new artist's details fill themselves in.

Bookmarklet · strict parsers

Convention Radar

Pulls in a show's 466-artist line-up or its winners board, and flags the artists I already follow.

Local-first · sync

Works offline

Edits and photos save on the device first, then sync when there's a connection.

The other models in the loop

OPENAI · CODEX

The artist

Generated all 18 demo tattoos with gpt-image. It writes code too, in its own worktrees.



OPENAI · CODEX

The correctness critic

Reviews every medium or large diff, read-only: bugs, security, edge cases. It has caught real state bugs before merge.

```
codex exec --sandbox read-only
```

GOOGLE · ANTIGRAVITY

The design critic

Reviews plans, UX and strategy. Caught an embedding-quality issue in the taste engine. Gemini also reads Instagram screenshots inside the app.

```
agy --print
```

About 1 in 5 critic findings is confidently wrong, so I check every one.

Same subject, two image models



LOCAL · MY MAC'S CPU

Stable Diffusion 1.5 with Flash LoRA. 512 px in 38 seconds, offline and free.



CLOUD · CODEX

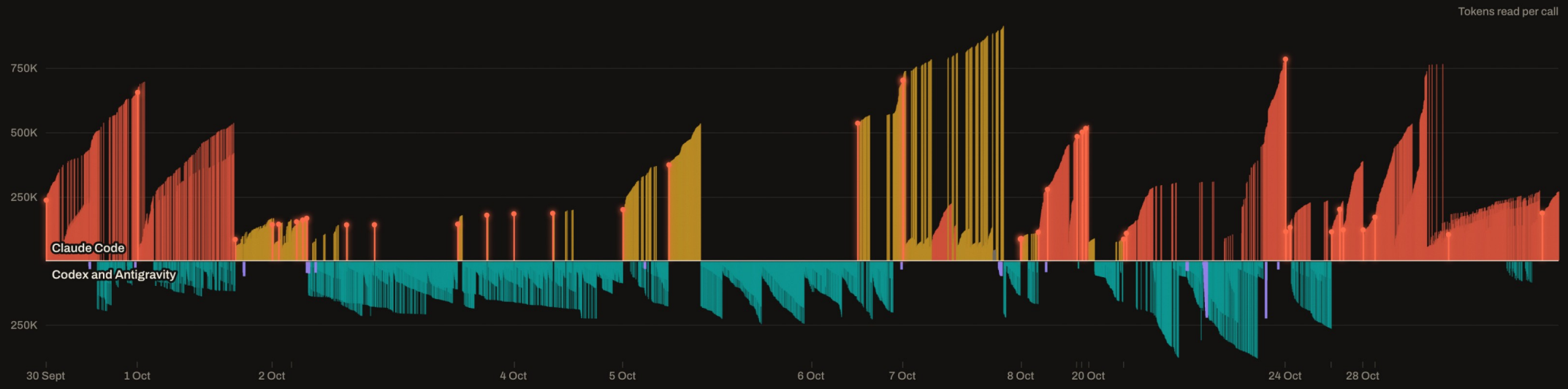
gpt-image. 1024 × 1536, one of the 18 demo tattoos.

Local is fine for placeholders and test images.

The demo has to sell the app, so it got the cloud model: real skin, light and fine linework.

Where the tokens go

The Sable AI Ledger: every Claude Code, Codex and Antigravity call, rebuilt from local logs each morning.



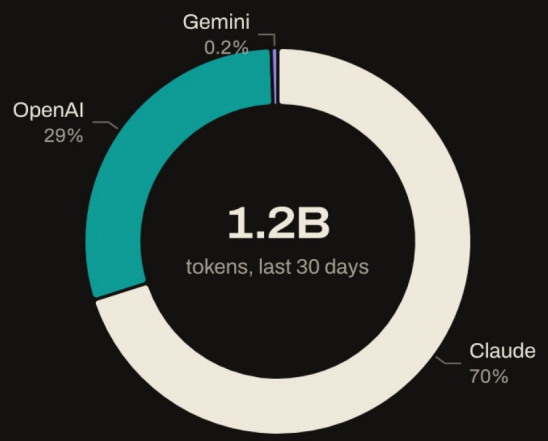
Opus 5.5 Sonnet 5.5 Codex Antigravity Other models Cache rebuild

Every call, 30 September to 29 October. Claude Code above the line; Codex and Antigravity below. Height is the tokens each call read.

Each ramp is one session: every reply re-reads everything before it, so it climbs until I clear it.

1.2 billion tokens in 30 days

By maker



By model

Each bar is one model's share of every token read and written, cache included, coloured by its maker.

Opus 5.5	Claude, in Claude Code and Antigravity	46%	532.9M
Sonnet 5.5	Claude, in Claude Code	24%	276.8M
GPT-6.1 Sol	OpenAI, in Codex	13%	150.2M
GPT-6 Sol	OpenAI, in Codex	7.9%	91M
Codex auto-review	OpenAI, in Codex	4.6%	52.9M
GPT-6 Astra	OpenAI, in Codex	3.3%	37.7M
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI, in Codex	0.7%	7.6M
Gemini 4 Argon	Gemini, in Antigravity	0.2%	1.8M
Gemini 3.6 Flash	Gemini, in Antigravity	0.1%	1.1M
Haiku 4.5	Claude, in Claude Code	<0.1%	496.7K

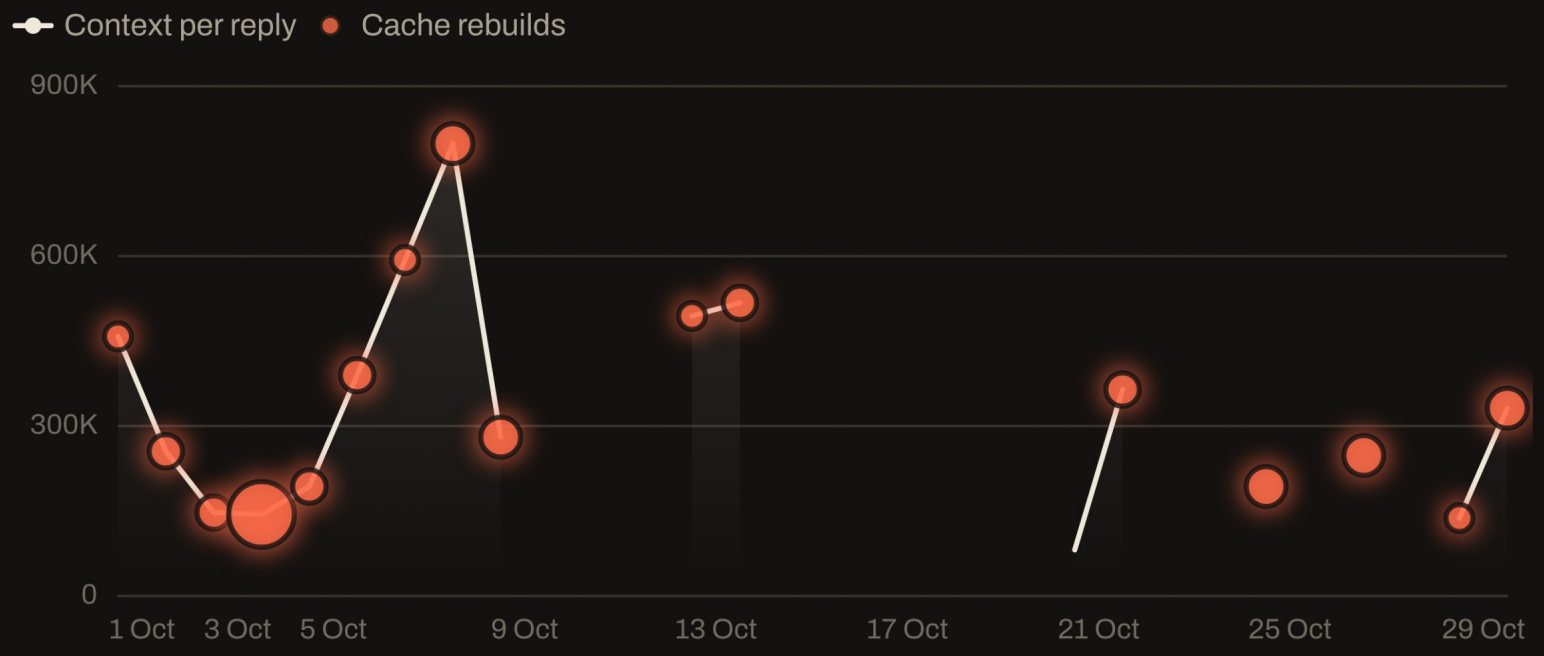
Every token read and written, cache included, across Claude Code, Codex and Antigravity, 30 September to 29 October.

8×

Re-reading context cost eight times what the models wrote.

$279 on cache reads and writes against $35 of output and thinking, at API list prices, 30 September to 29 October.

Context per reply, day by day



PEAK · 7 OCT

796K

tokens re-read by the average reply that day

SINCE 20 OCT

79–362K

Average tokens each main reply read, per day. Bubbles mark cache rebuilds, sized by how many. Gaps are days without Claude Code work.

What the data changed

70%

of Claude spend came from just two sessions, left running for 11 and 12 days.

One unit of work per session

Write the handoff on the GitHub issue, then clear and start fresh.

Don’t resume after a break

The prompt cache expires after an hour. 38 of 57 cache rebuilds followed a gap that long.

Wait, don’t poll

Run slow jobs in the background. Every poll re-reads the whole context.

Context per reply: 322K → 228K tokens, week on week.

THE TAKEAWAY

The agents write the code. My job is the system around them.

Issues, worktrees, cross-model critics, CI, and a ledger that keeps me honest about the cost.